Wealth Strategy Snapshot

Educational Analysis

2026 Tax Year Planning | Prepared for Elizabeth & Spouse Schlankey
March 2026 • Educational scenario modeling for discussion with licensed professionals

Executive Summary

This analysis explores tax optimization strategies and investment concepts for the 2026 tax year, tailored to your financial profile. As a high-income, married-filing-jointly household in Texas (no state income tax) with an existing LLC and strong interest in real estate, this snapshot models scenarios across tax efficiency, investment positioning, and short-term rental acquisition to illustrate first-year wealth-building potential.

Based on your current income ($300–399K), existing retirement contributions, and stated goals—reducing taxes by $45K+, generating new cash flows by Q3, and reaching a $5M net worth by age 45—this snapshot models potential first-year value ranging from **$90,653** (conservative scenario) to **$410,337** (aggressive scenario including real estate acquisition). Implementation of any strategy should be verified with your CPA and licensed financial advisor.

Incorporates One Big Beautiful Bill Act (OBBBA) provisions signed July 4, 2025, including permanent 100% bonus depreciation and updated contribution limits per IRS Rev. Proc. 2025-32.

CONSERVATIVE	AGGRESSIVE
$90,653	**$410,337**

Current Financial Position

Filing Status	Married Filing Jointly — Age 39 (no catch-up contributions for 2026)
Household Income	$300–399K combined · Elizabeth W-2: $150–199K · Spouse W-2: remaining balance
Location	Carrollton, TX — 0% state income tax · Est. federal marginal rate: 24%

Business Entity	Multi-Member LLC (2+ years) — currently no self-employment income; employed full-time elsewhere
Dependents	2 minor children + 1 adult child (18, college-bound)
Retirement	401(k): maxing at $23,500 (2025) — update to $24,500 for 2026 · HSA: maxing out · Backdoor Roth: annual
Home Equity	Own home — significant equity ($100K+) · Value ~$300K · Payment $3,700/mo
Credit	760+ score · Established business credit · $8K/mo discretionary after expenses
Liquid Capital	$250–499K available · Comfortable deploying $5–10K initially
Savings Reserve	4–6 months emergency fund · $10–24K in savings
Crypto Position	Small Bitcoin position (under 1%)
Investment Style	Moderate (balanced growth and stability) · 2–5 hrs/week available
Real Estate	Very interested — selected: co-hosting, arbitrage, ownership, commercial, syndications
Side-Income Skills	Product management, development, tech — consulting, coaching, freelance, e-commerce, content, IT
Primary Goals	1) Reduce tax bill by $45K+ · 2) Multiple new cash flows by Q3 · 3) $5M net worth by age 45

> *Data presented as provided in intake form. Verify all figures with your CPA and financial records.*

Timeline Awareness & Implementation Considerations (2026 Planning)

TIMEFRAME	DISCUSSION POINTS & CONSIDERATIONS
Week 1–2	**2025 Cleanup:** Review whether 2025 IRA contributions ($7,000 × 2 spouses = $14,000) and any remaining HSA contributions ($8,550) have been completed — deadline April 15, 2026. Discuss with CPA. **2026 401(k) Update:** Confirm both employers have updated deferral to $24,500 (2026 limit, up from $23,500). Contact HR/payroll if needed.
Week 2–3	**W-4 Review:** Discuss potential W-4 adjustments with CPA to optimize take-home pay. Over-withholding provides the government an interest-free loan — a common area for

	improvement. **LLC Revenue Activation:** Explore consulting, coaching, or freelance tech services through existing LLC. This is the key that may unlock Augusta Rule, home office deduction, and future Solo 401(k) eligibility. Discuss structuring with CPA.
Week 3–4	**STR Market Research:** If pursuing real estate, research DFW-area and destination markets for short-term rental opportunities. Under OBBBA, 100% bonus depreciation is now permanent for property acquired after January 19, 2025 — discuss cost segregation study timing and financing pre-approval with your CPA and RE professional. **Investment Scenario Review:** Schedule consultation with licensed financial advisor to discuss portfolio positioning, Bitcoin allocation, and STRC yield concepts outlined in Section 7.
Month 2–3	**Estate & Protection Planning:** Intake noted need for attorney/estate planner. Discuss entity structuring, asset protection, and basic estate documents — particularly relevant with college-age dependent and significant equity. **Q3 Cash-Flow Target:** Goal of several new cash flows by Q3 may be achievable through a combination of LLC income activation, investment yield, and/or STR acquisition. Map timeline with professional team.

> *These timeline items are provided for calendar awareness. Verify applicability and timing with your tax professional. Individual implementation timelines vary.*

2025 Tax Year: Remaining Opportunities (Before April 15, 2026)

2025 Strategies Still Available

The following 2025 contributions may still be made until April 15, 2026:

STRATEGY	2025 LIMIT	DEADLINE	YOUR OPPORTUNITY
Traditional / Roth IRA	$7,000 per spouse (no catch-up; age 39)	April 15, 2026	$14,000 total (×2 spouses) — already doing Backdoor Roth annually; confirm 2025 is complete
HSA (Family)	$8,550 (no catch-up; under 55)	April 15, 2026	Already maxing — confirm full $8,550 contributed for 2025

Solo 401(k) Employer	25% of net SE income	Tax filing + extensions	Requires existing plan + SE income — may not apply if LLC had no revenue in 2025
SEP IRA	25% up to $69,000	Tax filing + extensions	Alternative if no Solo 401(k) plan existed — discuss with CPA

No Longer Available for 2025: Employee 401(k) deferrals (Dec 31 deadline passed), W-4 adjustments (only affect 2026 forward), Augusta Rule rentals (must have occurred in 2025), Solo 401(k) employee contributions (Dec 31 deadline passed).

> *Verify 2025 contribution eligibility with your CPA. Making prior-year contributions requires careful coordination with your tax return.*

2026 Tax Optimization Strategies to Explore

Strategy Concept: 401(k) Maximization (Both Spouses) ALREADY ACTIVE

Potential Value: $11,760/year in tax deferral (at 24% marginal rate)

What It Is: Maximizing W-2 employer 401(k) contributions for both spouses. For 2026, the employee deferral limit increases to $24,500 per person (up from $23,500 in 2025). At age 39, no catch-up contributions apply. Combined deferral: $24,500 × 2 = $49,000 × 24% = $11,760 in potential tax savings.

How It Works:

1. Update payroll deferral to $24,500 for 2026 with both employers (confirm HR has applied 2026 limit)
2. Verify employer match is being captured in full — this is additional free compensation
3. Consider Roth vs. pre-tax allocation based on projected future tax rates — discuss with CPA

Eligibility Criteria: W-2 employment with 401(k) plan offered. No income limit for traditional 401(k) contributions.

> *Verify contribution limits and employer plan details with HR and your CPA. 2026 limits shown.*

Strategy Concept: HSA Family Maximization ALREADY ACTIVE

Potential Value: $2,100/year in tax savings (at 24% marginal rate)

What It Is: Health Savings Account contributions provide a triple tax advantage: tax-deductible going in, tax-free growth, tax-free withdrawals for medical expenses. The 2026 family limit is $8,750 (up from $8,550 in 2025). At age 39, no catch-up. Tax savings: $8,750 × 24% = $2,100.

How It Works:

1. Confirm 2026 contribution is set to $8,750 (new limit)
2. Invest HSA funds for long-term growth rather than using for current expenses (if cash flow allows)
3. Keep medical receipts — HSA can reimburse years later with no time limit

Eligibility Criteria: Must have High Deductible Health Plan (HDHP). Cannot be enrolled in Medicare or claimed as dependent.

> *Verify HDHP enrollment and updated 2026 limits with your benefits administrator. 2026 limits shown.*

Strategy Concept: Backdoor Roth IRA (Both Spouses) ALREADY ACTIVE

Potential Value: $15,000/year positioned for tax-free growth

What It Is: At your income level ($300–399K), direct Roth IRA contributions are phased out. The Backdoor Roth strategy involves contributing to a traditional IRA ($7,500 for 2026, up from $7,000 in 2025) and converting to Roth. At age 39, no catch-up applies. Combined: $7,500 × 2 = $15,000/year of tax-free growth positioning.

How It Works:

1. Contribute $7,500 to traditional IRA (non-deductible at your income)
2. Convert to Roth IRA promptly — ideally same day to minimize taxable gains
3. Ensure no existing traditional IRA balances (pro-rata rule) — discuss with CPA

Eligibility Criteria: No income limit on conversions. Pro-rata rule applies if traditional IRA balances exist. Must be done for each spouse individually.

> *Verify pro-rata rule implications and Form 8606 filing requirements with your CPA. 2026 limits shown.*

Strategy Concept: Augusta Rule (Section 280A) REQUIRES LLC REVENUE

Potential Value: $0 – $2,352 in tax savings

What It Is: IRC Section 280A allows a homeowner to rent their home to their own business for up to 14 days per year. The rental income is tax-free to the homeowner, while the business may deduct the rent as an ordinary business expense. At $700/day × 14 days = $9,800 income (tax-free); business deduction of $9,800 × 24% = $2,352 potential tax savings.

How It Works:

1. LLC must have active business revenue to create the deductible expense (currently no income through LLC)
2. Document fair market rental rate with comparable venue research (convention centers, hotels)
3. Execute formal lease agreement; maintain calendar records; pay via business account

Eligibility Criteria: Must own home, have a legitimate business entity with revenue, and limit to 14 days or fewer per year. Rental rate must be defensible at fair market value.

> *This strategy requires your LLC to generate revenue. Verify implementation requirements with your CPA. 2026 limits shown.*

Strategy Concept: Short-Term Rental + Cost Segregation HIGH IMPACT

Potential Value: $0 (conservative) – $25,000 (aggressive) first-year tax benefit

What It Is: Acquiring a short-term rental property (average stay ≤7 days) and performing a cost segregation study to accelerate depreciation. When the average guest stay is 7 days or fewer, the STR may avoid the passive activity rules, allowing depreciation to offset W-2 and other active income.

OBBBA Update (July 2025): The One Big Beautiful Bill Act permanently restored 100% bonus depreciation for qualified property acquired and placed in service after January 19, 2025. This reverses the TCJA phase-down schedule. Property acquired after this date qualifies for full first-year expensing of cost-segregated components.

Cost Segregation Methodology (Corrected for Building Basis):

1. **Purchase price:** $375,000 (modeled)
2. **Subtract land value (est. 20%):** $375,000 − $75,000 = $300,000 depreciable building basis
3. **Cost seg reclassification (25–40% of building basis):** $75,000 – $120,000 reclassified to 5/7/15-year property
4. **100% bonus depreciation (OBBBA):** $75,000 – $120,000 deducted in Year 1
5. **Remaining straight-line depreciation:** ($225,000 – $180,000) ÷ 27.5 = $6,545 – $8,182 Year 1
6. **Total Year 1 depreciation:** $83,182 – $126,545
7. **Tax savings at 24%:** $19,964 – $30,371 (modeled at ~$25,000 midpoint)

How It Works:

1. Acquire STR property (DFW area or destination market) — financing with 20% down (~$75K)
2. Commission cost segregation study from qualified engineering firm ($5,000–$8,000 cost)
3. Maintain average guest stay of 7 days or fewer; materially participate (100+ hours, more than anyone else)

Eligibility Criteria: Must materially participate in STR operations. Average guest stay must be 7 days or fewer to meet non-passive exception. Need sufficient income to absorb deduction. Does not require REPS status.

> *Real estate tax strategies have specific documentation and participation requirements. Work with a qualified tax professional to ensure compliance. Cost segregation applies to building basis (excluding*

> *land), not full property value. Bonus depreciation at 100% under OBBBA for property acquired after Jan 19, 2025. Verify current rates with CPA.*

Strategy Concept: Side-Business Income Activation (LLC) KEY UNLOCK

Potential Value: Unlocks multiple additional strategies (Augusta Rule, Home Office, future Solo 401(k))

What It Is: Your existing Multi-Member LLC has no current revenue. Activating income through your identified skills — consulting (product management, tech), coaching, freelance development, content creation — creates the business revenue necessary to support deductions for Augusta Rule, home office, vehicle, and eventually Solo 401(k) contributions. This is the single largest "strategy unlock" in this profile.

How It Works:

1. Identify highest-ROI service offering from your skills inventory (tech consulting typically commands $150–300/hr)
2. Generate LLC revenue; deductions become available proportional to business activity
3. Once SE income established, discuss S-Corp election and Solo 401(k) establishment with CPA (deadline: Dec 31, 2026 for employee deferrals)

Eligibility Criteria: Existing LLC, active business operations, and documented business income. Evaluate S-Corp election when SE income exceeds ~$50K to potentially reduce self-employment tax.

> *Entity structure optimization (LLC → S-Corp) and Solo 401(k) establishment should be discussed with your CPA and attorney. Timing is critical for 2026 contributions.*

Strategy Concept: Home Office Deduction

REQUIRES LLC REVENUE

Potential Value: $0 – $1,200 in tax savings

What It Is: With a dedicated room used exclusively for business (confirmed in intake), the home office deduction allows a portion of home expenses to be allocated as a business deduction. Simplified method: $5/sq ft up to 300 sq ft = $1,500 max; or actual expense method for potentially larger deduction. At $5,000 deduction × 24% = $1,200 potential savings.

How It Works:

1. Measure dedicated business-use space; document exclusive and regular use
2. Choose simplified ($5/sq ft × 300 max) or actual method (proportionate share of mortgage, utilities, insurance)
3. Requires business income to deduct against — linked to LLC activation strategy

Eligibility Criteria: Space must be used regularly and exclusively for business. Must have business income (W-2 employees cannot claim home office deduction on personal return).

> *Verify deduction method and documentation requirements with your CPA. 2026 rules apply.*

Strategy Concept: W-4 Withholding Optimization

REVIEW NEEDED

Potential Value: $2,400 – $6,000/year in improved cash flow

What It Is: Many dual-income households over-withhold federal taxes, effectively providing the government an interest-free loan. Reviewing and adjusting W-4 forms with your CPA can increase monthly take-home pay by $200–$500/month without changing your tax liability — the refund simply arrives throughout the year instead of as a lump sum.

How It Works:

1. CPA reviews current withholding vs. projected 2026 liability — particularly important after adding new deductions
2. Submit updated W-4 to employer(s) reflecting accurate withholding needs
3. Redirect additional take-home pay toward investment or debt reduction

Eligibility Criteria: Any W-2 employee. Most impactful for dual-income households where default withholding often results in overpayment.

> *W-4 adjustments should be calculated by your CPA to avoid underpayment penalties. Review annually or when circumstances change.*

Strategy Concept: Child Tax Credit (OBBBA Update) ALREADY ACTIVE

Potential Value: $4,400 CTC + $500 Other Dependent Credit = $4,900 total credits

What It Is: Under OBBBA, the Child Tax Credit increased to $2,200 per qualifying child under 17 (up from $2,000 under TCJA). This is now permanent and indexed for inflation starting in 2026. With 2 minor children: $2,200 × 2 = $4,400 in direct tax credits. The college-bound 18-year-old may qualify for the $500 Other Dependent Credit (now permanent under OBBBA).

How It Works:

1. Claimed on annual tax return — dollar-for-dollar reduction of tax liability
2. Up to $1,700 per child is refundable through the Additional Child Tax Credit
3. Phaseout begins at $400,000 MAGI for MFJ — at your income level, you are likely within range for full credit

Eligibility Criteria: Qualifying child must be under 17, a U.S. citizen with SSN. Both taxpayer and child must have valid SSNs (new OBBBA requirement). Phaseout: $50 reduction per $1,000 over $400K MAGI (MFJ).

> *This credit is likely already being claimed. The OBBBA increased the per-child amount by $200. Verify eligibility for the 18-year-old under the Other Dependent Credit with your CPA.*

Primary Strategy Education: Short-Term Rental & Business Activation

Why These Two Strategies May Be Central to Your Profile

Your intake responses indicate strong alignment with both STR investing (Q42: very interested; Q43: 5 RE categories selected) and business income activation (Q50: 8 skill categories identified). Together, these two strategies may create a compounding effect: business income unlocks tax deductions, while STR acquisition potentially generates both cash flow and significant first-year depreciation offsets against your W-2 income.

Short-Term Rental: The Math Behind Cost Segregation

COMPONENT	CONSERVATIVE	AGGRESSIVE	NOTES
Property Acquisition Price	$350,000 – $400,000 (modeled at $375,000)		DFW area or destination market

Down Payment (20%)	$75,000		Conventional financing
Land Value (est. 20%)	$75,000 (not depreciable)		Subtracted before cost seg
Depreciable Building Basis	$300,000		$375K − $75K land
Cost Seg Reclassification	25% of building basis	40% of building basis	$75K – $120K to 5/7/15-yr property
100% Bonus Depreciation (OBBBA)	$75,000	$120,000	Full first-year deduction
Remaining Straight-Line (Year 1)	$8,182	$6,545	Remaining basis ÷ 27.5 years
Total Year 1 Depreciation	$83,182	$126,545	Bonus + straight-line
Tax Savings (× 24%)	**$19,964**	**$30,371**	At 24% federal marginal rate
Projected NOI (Annual)	$25,000	$35,000	After expenses, management
Property Appreciation (3–6%)	$10,500	$22,500	Market-dependent

Key requirement: Average guest stay must be 7 days or fewer to qualify for the non-passive activity exception. Material participation (100+ hours, more than any other individual) must be documented. This does not require Real Estate Professional Status (REPS), which has a much higher 750-hour threshold.

OBBBA Note: Under prior TCJA phase-down rules, bonus depreciation would have been only 20% for property placed in service in 2026. The OBBBA permanent restoration of 100% bonus depreciation significantly increases the first-year tax benefit of cost segregation for newly acquired property.

Business Income Activation: The “Unlock” Strategy

Your existing LLC and identified skills create an immediate opportunity. Here is what becomes available at various revenue levels:

LLC REVENUE LEVEL	STRATEGIES UNLOCKED	POTENTIAL ADDITIONAL TAX BENEFIT

$1 – $10,000	Augusta Rule, Home Office, Vehicle Deduction	$1,200 – $3,552 (deductions × 24%)
$10,001 – $50,000	Above + QBI Deduction (20% of qualified income)	$3,552 – $6,400
$50,001+	Above + S-Corp election evaluation + Solo 401(k)	$6,400+ (Solo 401(k) alone could add $5,880–$17,280 in tax savings)

Your skill inventory (product management, development, tech consulting, coaching) typically commands $150–$300/hour in the market. Even 5–10 hours/month of consulting could generate $9,000–$36,000 annually through the LLC, unlocking the majority of strategies above.

> *Real estate tax strategies have specific documentation and participation requirements. Business income strategies require proper entity structuring. Work with your CPA and attorney to ensure compliance before implementation. Scenarios shown are illustrative estimates based on stated assumptions.*

Illustrative Portfolio Scenario

Profile basis: Moderate investment approach (Q41) · Growth + cash-flow goals (Q46) · 2–5 hrs/week available (Q44) · Existing small Bitcoin position (Q40)

Capital modeled: Conservative: $7,500 (Q45 midpoint) · Aggressive: $375,000 (Q26 midpoint of $250–499K)

ASSET CLASS	SCENARIO %	CONSERVATIVE ($7,500)	AGGRESSIVE ($375,000)	EDUCATIONAL RATIONALE
Bitcoin	55%	$4,125	$206,250	Bitcoin serves as a core wealth accumulation vehicle due to its fixed 21M supply and increasing institutional adoption. Aligns with aggressive growth goal of $5M by 45.
STRC	25%	$1,875	$93,750	STRC is commonly used by investors seeking passive income with Bitcoin correlation, providing approximately 10–12% annual yield. Supports Q3 cash-flow goal.

VTI / VOO	20%	$1,500	$75,000	VTI offers broad U.S. equity exposure at low cost (0.03% expense ratio). VOO tracks the S&P 500. Provides diversification and stability.

This scenario models one approach based on the moderate, growth-focused profile and desire for both appreciation and passive income indicated. The 55% Bitcoin allocation reflects the balance between the aggressive $5M net-worth goal and the moderate risk tolerance stated. Specific investment decisions should be made in consultation with a licensed financial advisor who understands your complete situation. Verify current STRC yield at time of investment. Historical yields shown are not guaranteed.

Modeled First-Year Value Summary (2026 Tax Year)

Capital deployed: Conservative $7,500 (Q45) · Aggressive $375,000 (Q26) · Marginal tax rate: 24% federal · Age 39 (no catch-up) · Texas (0% state) · OBBBA provisions applied

CAT.	ITEM	CONSERVATIVE	AGGRESSIVE	CALCULATION BASIS
CATEGORY A: TAX OPTIMIZATION STRATEGIES				
Tax	401(k) Max (×2 spouses: $24,500 × 2)	$11,760	$11,760	$49,000 × 24%
Tax	HSA Family ($8,750)	$2,100	$2,100	$8,750 × 24%
Tax	Augusta Rule (14 days × $700)	$0	$2,352	$9,800 × 24% (requires LLC revenue)
Tax	Home Office Deduction	$0	$1,200	~$5,000 deduction × 24%
Tax	STR + Cost Segregation (OBBBA: 100% bonus dep)	$0	$25,000	Building basis $300K, 25–40% reclassified, 100% bonus dep, midpoint × 24%
	Tax Optimization Subtotal	**$13,860**	**$42,412**	
CATEGORY B: INVESTMENT INCOME (YIELD / DIVIDENDS)				

Income	STRC Yield (10–12%)	$188	$11,250	$1,875 × 10% / $93,750 × 12%
Income	ETF Dividends (1.5–2%)	$23	$1,500	$1,500 × 1.5% / $75,000 × 2%
	Investment Income Subtotal	**$211**	**$12,750**	
CATEGORY C: INVESTMENT APPRECIATION (PROJECTED GROWTH)				
Growth	Bitcoin Appreciation (25–50%)	$1,031	$103,125	$4,125 × 25% / $206,250 × 50%
Growth	STRC Appreciation (15–30%)	$281	$28,125	$1,875 × 15% / $93,750 × 30%
Growth	VTI/VOO Appreciation (8–12%)	$120	$9,000	$1,500 × 8% / $75,000 × 12%
	Appreciation Subtotal	**$1,432**	**$140,250**	
CATEGORY D: REAL ESTATE (AGGRESSIVE ONLY — Q42=YES, Q43=5 TYPES SELECTED)				
RE	STR Annual Cash Flow (NOI)	$0	$30,000	After expenses; market dependent
RE	Property Appreciation (~4.5%)	$0	$16,875	$375,000 × 4.5%
RE	Mortgage Principal Paydown (Yr 1)	$0	$4,500	Standard amortization estimate
	Real Estate Subtotal	**$0**	**$51,375**	**Conservative = no RE acquisition**
CATEGORY E: CASH FLOW IMPROVEMENTS				
Cash Flow	W-4 Optimization ($200–$500/mo)	$2,400	$6,000	$200/mo × 12 / $500/mo × 12
	Cash Flow Subtotal	**$2,400**	**$6,000**	
CATEGORY F: WEALTH BUILDING (DOLLARS POSITIONED)				

Wealth	401(k) Contributions (2026: $24,500 × 2)	$49,000	$49,000	Age 39 — no catch-up
Wealth	HSA Contribution (2026: $8,750 family)	$8,750	$8,750	Triple tax advantage
Wealth	Backdoor Roth IRA (×2: $7,500 each)	$15,000	$15,000	Tax-free growth positioning
Wealth	Augusta Rule Income Received	$0	$9,800	Tax-free under 14-day rule
Wealth	RE Equity Position (20% down)	$0	$75,000	$375K property × 20%
	Wealth Building Subtotal	**$72,750**	**$157,550**	
TOTAL MODELED FIRST-YEAR VALUE (2026)		**$90,653**	**$410,337**	

Verification

Conservative: $13,860 + $211 + $1,432 + $0 + $2,400 + $72,750 = **$90,653**

Aggressive: $42,412 + $12,750 + $140,250 + $51,375 + $6,000 + $157,550 = **$410,337**

> *Projected values are illustrative estimates for the 2026 tax year based on assumptions stated. Investment appreciation is based on modeled growth rates and is not guaranteed — past performance does not guarantee future results. All investments carry risk including potential loss of principal. Bitcoin and cryptocurrency are highly volatile. Real estate projections depend on market conditions, occupancy, and expenses. Tax savings shown use 2026 IRS limits and OBBBA provisions (100% bonus depreciation for post-Jan 19, 2025 acquisitions); verify with your CPA. Consult with your licensed professionals before implementation.*

Calendar Awareness & Key Dates (2026)

DATE	ITEM	RELEVANCE

April 15, 2026	2025 IRA/Roth IRA contribution deadline	Last day to contribute $7,000 × 2 for 2025 tax year
April 15, 2026	2025 HSA contribution deadline	Last day to contribute $8,550 (family) for 2025
April 15, 2026	2025 Tax return filing deadline	File or extend; finalize 2025 strategies with CPA
Q2–Q3 2026	STR acquisition window (if pursuing)	Allows time for cost seg study and full-year depreciation benefit. 100% bonus dep available under OBBBA.
Oct 15, 2026	Extended 2025 return deadline	Solo 401(k) employer contributions and SEP IRA for 2025 (if applicable)
Dec 31, 2026	Solo 401(k) plan establishment	Must be established by Dec 31 for 2026 employee deferrals
Dec 31, 2026	2026 401(k) employee deferral deadline	$24,500 per spouse; confirm payroll is on track
Dec 31, 2026	Augusta Rule rentals must occur	14-day rental must take place within calendar year
April 15, 2027	2026 IRA/HSA contribution deadline	$7,500 IRA + $8,750 HSA (2026 limits)

> *Verify all deadlines with your tax professional. Dates may shift for weekends/holidays.*

Questions for Your Professional Team

For Your CPA / Tax Professional

? "Based on our combined income and ages (both under 50), what are our maximum 2026 retirement contributions across 401(k), HSA, and Backdoor Roth?"

? "Are we over-withholding on our W-4s? What adjustment would optimize our monthly take-home without risking underpayment penalties?"

? "If we generate consulting income through our LLC this year, at what revenue level should we consider S-Corp election and Solo 401(k) establishment?"

? "For a short-term rental acquisition, what documentation do we need for cost segregation and material participation to ensure deductions hold up? With OBBBA restoring 100% bonus depreciation, how does this affect our Year 1 tax position?"

? "Can we still make 2025 IRA and HSA contributions before April 15? Are there any pro-rata issues with our Backdoor Roth conversions?"

? "Given our Amazon FBA experience — are there any 2025 losses or deductions we should capture on this year's return?"

? "Are we receiving the full $2,200 CTC per child under OBBBA, and does our 18-year-old qualify for the $500 Other Dependent Credit?"

For Your Financial Advisor

? "How should we think about Bitcoin allocation within our overall portfolio given our 6-year timeline to $5M net worth?"

? "What are the risks and mechanics of STRC as a yield vehicle? How does it correlate with direct Bitcoin exposure?"

? "What international diversification options exist that could help protect against dollar devaluation concerns (as noted in intake)?"

For Your Attorney / Estate Planner

? "What estate documents do we need with three children (including a college-bound 18-year-old) and growing real estate holdings?"

? "Should our LLC structure be modified before we start generating consulting revenue or acquiring real estate?"

Professional Team Considerations

ROLE	WHAT TO DISCUSS	STATUS

CPA / Tax Professional	All tax strategies, 2025 cleanup, 2026 planning, W-4 optimization, S-Corp evaluation, cost segregation coordination (OBBBA bonus dep), Solo 401(k) establishment	Review current CPA's knowledge of strategies (noted concern about Backdoor Roth awareness)
Attorney / Estate Planner	LLC restructuring, estate documents, asset protection, trusts for minor children	Identified as needed in intake — priority for 2026
Licensed Financial Advisor	Investment portfolio construction, Bitcoin positioning, STRC yield evaluation, international diversification, risk management	To be established — critical for investment implementation
RE Professional / Agent	STR market analysis (DFW + destination markets), property identification, financing, property management options	To be established if pursuing STR strategy
Cost Segregation Firm	Engineering-based study for any RE acquisition; must be completed in year of purchase for maximum benefit. 100% bonus dep available under OBBBA for post-Jan 19, 2025 acquisitions.	Engage after property acquisition

Progress Milestones & Checkpoint Considerations

TIMEFRAME	MILESTONE CONSIDERATION	KEY METRIC TO REVIEW
End of Q1 (Mar 2026)	2025 cleanup contributions completed; 2026 401(k)/HSA updated to new limits	Confirm $24,500/spouse 401(k) + $8,750 HSA on track
End of Q2 (Jun 2026)	LLC revenue activation progress; W-4 adjustments implemented; RE market research underway	First LLC invoice sent; monthly take-home increase visible
End of Q3 (Sep 2026)	New cash-flow sources established (per Goal #2); STR under contract or operational	Monthly passive income tracking; STR bookings pipeline
End of Q4 (Dec 2026)	Solo 401(k) established (if LLC income warrants); Augusta Rule rentals documented; all 2026 contributions on track	Total 2026 tax savings estimated; net worth updated
April 2027	2026 tax return review — compare projected vs. actual savings	Actual tax reduction achieved vs. $45K+ goal

> *These milestones are for discussion and calendar awareness purposes. Actual timing depends on individual circumstances and professional guidance.*

2026 Contribution Limits Reference

ACCOUNT TYPE	BASE LIMIT	CATCH-UP (50+)	SUPER CATCH-UP (60–63)	YOUR 2026 LIMIT (AGE 39)
401(k) Employee Deferral	$24,500	+$8,000	+$11,250	$24,500 per spouse
401(k) Total (Employee + Employer)	$72,000	+$8,000	+$11,250	$72,000 (if Solo 401k)
HSA (Family Coverage)	$8,750	+$1,000 (55+)	N/A	$8,750
HSA (Individual Coverage)	$4,400	+$1,000 (55+)	N/A	N/A (family plan)
Traditional / Roth IRA	$7,500	+$1,100	N/A	$7,500 per spouse
Business Mileage Rate	72.5¢ per mile (2026)			Track all business miles

SECURE 2.0 Note: Starting in 2026, if either spouse earned $150,000+ in FICA wages in 2025 from the same employer, their catch-up contributions must be made as Roth (not pre-tax). At age 39, catch-up contributions do not yet apply — but this rule will be relevant beginning at age 50. Discuss with CPA for future planning.

OBBBA Additional Provisions (2026):
• **Child Tax Credit:** $2,200 per qualifying child under 17 (up from $2,000); $500 Other Dependent Credit for dependents who don't qualify. Now permanent and indexed for inflation.
• **Non-Itemizer Charitable Deduction (NEW):** Starting 2026, non-itemizers can deduct up to $2,000 (MFJ) in cash charitable contributions. At 24%, potential savings of $480.
• **Section 179 Expanded:** Maximum deduction increased to $2,500,000 (phase-out at $4,000,000). Relevant for business equipment and qualifying property.
• **SALT Cap:** Raised to $40,000 (from $10,000). Less impactful in Texas (0% state income tax) but relevant if acquiring property in states with income tax.
• **Standard Deduction (MFJ):** $32,200 for 2026.

> *Verify all limits at IRS.gov or with your tax professional. Limits shown are for the 2026 tax year per IRS Rev. Proc. 2025-32.*

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Tax Law Changes: Tax laws change regularly. Information presented reflects understanding as of March 2026 using 2026 IRS limits per Rev. Proc. 2025-32, incorporating One Big Beautiful Bill Act (OBBBA) provisions signed July 4, 2025, including permanent 100% bonus depreciation, expanded Section 179, updated SALT cap, and Child Tax Credit increases. Verify current rules with your tax professional.

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